



Transport on the trail

The Viet Cong transported supplies by any means possible, including by bicycle. In 1967, *New York Times* war correspondent Harrison Salisbury told the US Senate that without bikes, the Viet Cong would be forced to get out of the war.

Defending the trail

Battalions of North Vietnamese regulars were assigned to defend the trail's flanks against possible ground attack. To protect it from bombing, elaborate anti-aircraft defenses were set up at key points along the trail. Underground barracks, workshops, hospitals, fuel dumps, and storage facilities were also constructed.

The number of infiltrators rose, reaching an average of 4,500 soldiers a month by 1966 and 6,000 a month the year after that. As even the US government reluctantly came to realize, what the North Vietnamese had created was one of the great military engineering achievements of the 20th century.